

BREAKER-WARD CONTRACT OF FENSPIRE

Let it be entered beneath the ash-seal and read before the watch:

Fenspire stands in the Gloaming Reach, founded in 57 AS, and remains a core location of the realm. Its garrisoned status shall not be disputed, diminished, or *spoken of as a temporary inconvenience*. Its garrison is 3,742, and those counted beneath its walls are charged to vigilance, wall-duty, and the preservation of the living from what rises in the fen.

ARTICLE I — OF THE THREAT

The Marsh Revenant is acknowledged by this contract as a siege-breaker, defined by its ability to shatter fortified resistance. It is a *revenant of stagnant, hostile ground, and its presence turns defense into desperation*.

It appears as a corpse-like figure burdened with marsh-wet decay and the grim solidity of a breaker of walls. It projects tireless, impersonal hostility, advancing with the inevitability of the dead.

Any signer who calls it a beast, raider, or common corpse accepts the consequences of that error. Such words have undone stronger walls than *these*.

ARTICLE II — OF FENSPIRE

The parties recognize the silhouette of Fenspire: a stark spire rising above the dim character of the Gloaming Reach. Its atmosphere is shaped by permanent military occupation, and it projects disciplined vigilance.

The garrison shall maintain watch upon approaches, foundations, gates, and all ground where stagnant water may conceal hostile movement. No watchman shall abandon a post merely because the marsh is quiet. Quiet is not peace. Quiet is the Revenant listening.

ARTICLE III — DUTIES OF THE SIGNERS

The undersigned shall:

- *report any sighting of the Marsh Revenant without embellishment or concealment;*

- preserve written accounts of damage to walls, doors, towers, and defensive works;
- deny the creature access to fortified resistance by whatever lawful defense remains at hand;
- obey the appointed voice during an alarm, unless that voice commands the opening of the gates to the Marsh Revenant;
- provide aid to the garrison of 3,742, without claiming that numbers alone make Fenspire safe.

No signer shall pursue the Marsh Revenant into stagnant ground for glory, proof, payment, or the relief of wounded pride. The dead do not admire courage.

ARTICLE IV — BREACH AND PENALTY

If a signer abandons assigned duty, conceals a warning, or weakens a defense, the breach shall be recorded against that signer's mark and possessions as the lawful authority determines. If the signer survives long enough to answer.

This contract remains binding while Fenspire retains its garrisoned status and while the Marsh Revenant remains a threat to its walls.

Marks of assent: _____ Witness mark:

_____ Date of entry: _____